For a **System and Network Administration Team Leader** role, the questions usually go beyond basic commands or concepts. They test both **technical expertise** and **leadership/strategic skills**. Here's a structured breakdown of the types of questions you can expect:

---

1. Technical Knowledge (Advanced)

These assess your deep hands-on skills in Linux, Windows, networking, and security. Examples:

Linux/Unix Administration

- Managing users, groups, and permissions.
- Automating tasks with scripts (Bash, PowerShell).
- Monitoring system performance (`top`, `vmstat`, `iostat`).
- Troubleshooting services and daemons (e.g., `systemctl`, `journalctl`).

Windows Server Administration

- Active Directory, GPOs, DNS, DHCP.
- PowerShell scripting.
- Windows Server roles and features.
- Backup and recovery strategies.

Networking

- TCP/IP, routing, VLANs, subnetting.
- Firewalls, NAT, VPNs.
- Network troubleshooting (`ping`, `traceroute`, `netstat`, `tcpdump`).
- Load balancers, proxy servers.

Security

- Access control, user permissions, and auditing.
- Patch management and vulnerability scanning.
- Firewalls, IDS/IPS configuration.
- SSL/TLS certificates, secure protocols.

Virtualization / Cloud

- Hypervisors (VMware, Hyper-V, KVM) management.
- Cloud services (AWS, Azure, GCP) deployment and monitoring.
- Container orchestration (Docker, Kubernetes).

Example Questions:

- How do you troubleshoot high CPU usage on a Linux server?
- Explain the process of setting up a redundant firewall cluster.
- How do you migrate a Windows AD domain controller with minimal downtime?

---

2. System Design & Architecture

These questions test your ability to **design scalable, reliable, and secure IT infrastructure**.

- Designing HA (High Availability) clusters for servers.
- Disaster recovery planning and implementation.
- Network topology design for enterprise.
- Storage solutions (NAS, SAN, cloud storage).

Example Questions:

- How would you design a resilient email infrastructure for 5000+ users?
- Describe a disaster recovery plan for critical business applications.
- How do you implement network segmentation for security?

---

3. Troubleshooting & Problem-Solving

Scenario-based questions to test your **analytical thinking** and **real-world troubleshooting skills**.

Examples:

- Users report intermittent network drops—how would you investigate?
- A web server responds slowly; logs show high I/O—what's your approach?
- DNS resolution fails intermittently—what steps do you take to identify the root cause?

---

4. Leadership & Management

Since it's a **Team Leader** role, expect questions on **people management, process, and decision-making**.

- Team coordination and workload allocation.
- Incident response leadership.
- Project management and change management.
- Documentation, compliance, and SLA management.

Example Questions:

- How do you handle conflicts within your IT team?
- Describe how you ensure your team meets SLA targets.
- How do you prioritize multiple critical incidents occurring simultaneously?

---

5. Automation & Optimization

Expect questions on improving efficiency using **scripts, tools, or processes**.

- Automating backups, monitoring, or deployment tasks.
- Using configuration management tools (Ansible, Puppet, Chef).
- Performance tuning for servers and networks.

Example Questions:

- How would you automate patch management across 200 Linux servers?
- Explain a script or tool you used to reduce repetitive administrative tasks.

---

6. Security & Compliance

Questions around protecting infrastructure and ensuring regulatory compliance.

- Securing servers and network devices.
- Monitoring logs for anomalies.
- Compliance standards (ISO 27001, GDPR, PCI DSS).

Example Questions:

- How do you secure SSH access for multiple Linux servers?
- Explain your approach to auditing user access and permissions.